



The Marvellous Neighbourhood

Level 8 · Reading Champion

Our Sounds

Read every sound out loud before you start the story. Then meet this book's new sounds — they're in colour.

ALL OUR SOUNDS SO FAR

ire	ore	ear	oor
ure	tion	ous	

TODAY'S NEW SOUND



SHIFTY SOUNDS



says /oo/ short
as in **good**



says /oo/ short
as in **full**

Story Words

Sound out each phoneme, then blend. Underlines show letters that work together.

marvellous
· _ . . _ _

glorious
· . _ . _

enormous
· . _ . _

fabulous
· . . . _

joyous
· _ _

famous
· . _

WATCH OUT — HOW TO SAY

corniche → cor · neesh **Egypt** → ee · jipt

neighbourhood → nay · ber · hood

Yusuf sat on the front steps of his block of flats and frowned at the street below. Rows of cream-coloured blocks lined the road, and cars honked in the hot afternoon heat. From the market around the corner, he could hear the calls of vendors and the clatter of carts.

"Nothing glorious or fabulous ever happens here," he muttered. "This place is so ordinary." Just then, his Uncle Tarek sat down quietly on the step beside him, a worn notebook tucked under his arm.



"You look like somebody who thinks they have seen everything there is to see," said Uncle Tarek with a smile. Yusuf shrugged. "I live here. It is just houses, traffic and the same old market." His uncle had a luminous look in his eyes, as if he knew something tremendous. "I have spent my whole life travelling to marvellous places," he said, leaning forward. "And I am going to tell you something, Yusuf. This is one of the most glorious cities on Earth."



Uncle Tarek stood and walked with Yusuf to the wide road that ran along the edge of the river. "That is the Nile," he said in a wondrous voice, "the most famous river in the whole world." "It has flowed past this very spot for thousands and thousands of years." Yusuf had walked along the corniche countless times, but he had never stopped to wonder. He looked at the grey-green water as if he was seeing it for the very first time.



Next, his uncle led Yusuf around the corner to the old bakery on their street. An enormous cloud of warm bread smell drifted out through the open door. "The baker has been here for forty years," said Uncle Tarek. "He knows every family by name." Yusuf realised he had never once stopped to wave or say good morning to him. The baker spotted them and held out a warm round of aish baladi, the famous flat bread of Egypt.



They walked on, and Uncle Tarek pointed to the slim minaret that rose above the rooftops. "On quiet mornings, the call from that tower can be heard for miles and miles," he said. Down by the river, white-sailed boats drifted past on the gleaming water. A cluster of street cats — Cairo was famous for its cats — sunned themselves on a warm wall. "Is this place still boring to you?" his uncle asked, his eyes twinkling.



Yusuf stood still for a moment and looked around with new, curious eyes. He could see the white-sailed boats drifting on the enormous Nile, golden in the afternoon haze. He could hear the joyous calls of the market sellers drifting around the corner. He could smell the fabulous bread from the bakery he had walked past hundreds of times. "It is marvellous," he said, in a quiet, amazed voice. "My neighbourhood is truly marvellous."



Uncle Tarek smiled and handed Yusuf a small notebook and a pen. "Write down what you see," he said. "Give each part of your neighbourhood the name it deserves." Yusuf picked up the pen and began to write, one label for each place he could now see. He wrote: The Marvellous Corniche. The Enormous Nile. The Famous Bakery. The Joyous Market. The Glorious Minaret. "These are the tremendous things that make up my home," said Yusuf, and he felt proud.



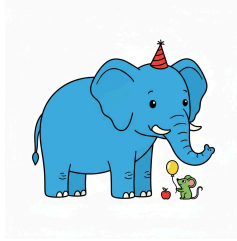
Later, when Uncle Tarek had gone home, Yusuf sat on his step once more. But this time, he was not bored — he was curious and adventurous, watching the world with new eyes. The enormous city hummed and buzzed all around him, full of marvellous, ordinary life. He opened his notebook and added one last label at the bottom of the page: My Marvellous Home. And from that day on, Yusuf never forgot that the most glorious place in the world was the one right outside his door.



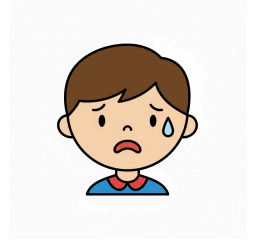
Sound Spotlight

ous

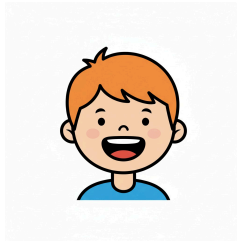
Find this sound in the words on the right.



enormous



nervous



joyous

Trace & Form the Sounds

Trace the grey letters, then carry on along the line yourself. Say the sound as you write.

ous

o, u, s: says /us/

ous

NOW WRITE EACH WORD

marvellous

glorious

enormous

fabulous

joyous

famous

Alien Words Challenge

These aren't real words! Use your phonics to sound them out.

stamous

grumous

trainous

floatous

clumous

spendous

SOUND DETECTIVE

Say each sound, then find and circle it in its words.

ch

says /k/ as in school

school

chorus

echo

ch

says /sh/ as in chef

chef

chalet

machine

Can You Read These?

Sound out each word, then blend it. Use the buttons under each word.

m a r v e l l o u s
· — · · — —

g l o r i o u s
· · — ♦ —

e n o r m o u s
· · — · —

f a b u l o u s
· · · ♦ · —

j o y o u s
· — —

f a m o u s
· ♦ · —

READ AND CHOOSE THE WORD

Read each sentence. Which word fills the gap? Circle it.

"My neighbourhood is truly _____."

marvellous

fabulous

enormous

The _____ Nile.

enormous

glorious

fabulous

The _____ Minaret.

enormous

fabulous

glorious

Tell the Story

Number the pictures 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 in the order they happened. Then retell the story out loud in your own words.



Your Turn to Write

Retell what happened in the story. Use the starters and tick a goal as you remember it.

WRITING GOALS — TICK WHEN YOU REMEMBER

- ☐ **Aa** Capital at the start
- ☐ **␣** Finger spaces
- ☐ **. ? !** Correct end mark
- ☐ **↔** Joining word: and / but / because
- ☐ **“ ”** Inverted commas for speech

KEYWORDS — USE THESE IN YOUR RETELL

marvellous glorious enormous fabulous joyous famous

PARAGRAPH RETELL *At first, ... Then, ... In the end, ...*

At first,

Then,

In the end,

Talk About It

FINDING

What is the name of the famous river that runs past Yusuf's neighbourhood?

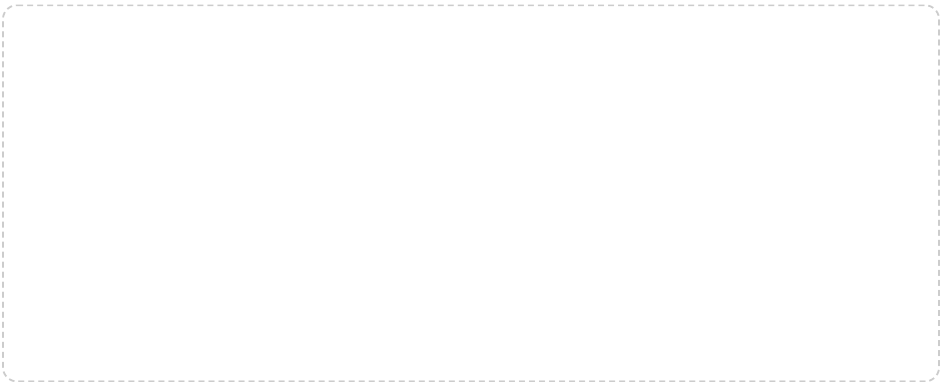
THINKING

Why do you think Yusuf never noticed how marvellous his neighbourhood was before?

WORDS

The word 'glorious' ends in -ous. Can you find three more -ous words in the story?

DRAW YOUR FAVOURITE PART



It made me feel _____

Circle one:



Shifty Sounds — Grow the Code

Different spellings can make the same sound. Read down each column — every spelling underneath makes the sound at the top. The **faded** spellings are still locked: your child meets those in later books, and the chart fills in as they grow.

CONSONANT SOUNDS

s	t	n	m	d	k	r	h	f	j	v	w	z	sh	ch	th ^{thin}	th ^{this}	ng	zh ^{vision}
s	t	n	m	d	k	r	h	f	j	v	w	z	sh	ch			ng	
ss	ed	kn	mb	ed	c	wr	wh	ff	g	ve	wh	zz	ch	tch			n	s
c		gn			ck			ph	ge			s	ti					si
ce					ch			gh	dge			se	ci					ge
se					que								ssi					
													s					

VOWEL SOUNDS

a	e	i	o	u	ai	ee	igh	oa	oo ^{moon}
a	e	i	o	u	ai	ee	igh	oa	oo
	ea	y	a	o	ay	e	i-e	ow	u-e
				ou	a-e	ea	ie	o-e	ew
					ey	e-e	y	oe	ue
					a	y	i	o	ou
					eigh	ey			ui
					ea	ie			

VOWEL SOUNDS (CONTINUED)

oo ^{book}	ar	or	ur	ow	oi	air	ear	uh ^{butter}
oo	ar	or	ur	ow	oi	air	ear	er
u	a	aw	ir	ou	oy	are	eer	a
ou		au	er			ere	ere	o
		augh	or			ear		our
		ore	ear					re
		oor						
		oar						
		our						

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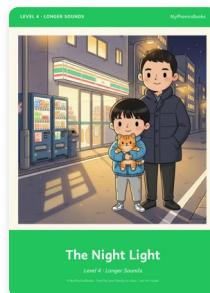
● Level 1



● Level 2



● Level 3



● Level 4



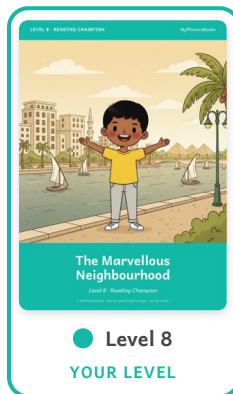
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YOUR LEVEL



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